

Let's turn now to a second, shorter argument in favor of immaterial
souls.

Consider my body. It has many parts: my arms, my legs, etc. But it also has parts we don't have ready names for. For example, there is all of my body besides my right arm. And all of me besides my left big toe. And ...

This shows that there are in fact many overlapping physical things in your seat right now. By itself, that is arguably not especially puzzling.

There is at least one thing (hopefully) thinking in your seat right now.

If there are no immaterial souls, then that thing is a material thing.

What would it take for a material thing to think? Presumably, if material things can think, thinking is just a matter of that material thing having a certain kind of complex physical organization. Maybe it would have to have some kind of complex information-processing features analogous to our brain. Let's call these the **thinking-relevant physical properties**,

But note that many of the distinct physical things sitting in your seat right now have the thinking-relevant properties. For example, the object which is all of you other than your left thumb's fingernail would seem to.

So, if material things can think, there are a huge number of distinct
thinking things in your seat right now.

But that is absurd. So, material things cannot think. Since you can think, you must be (at least in part) an immaterial soul.

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